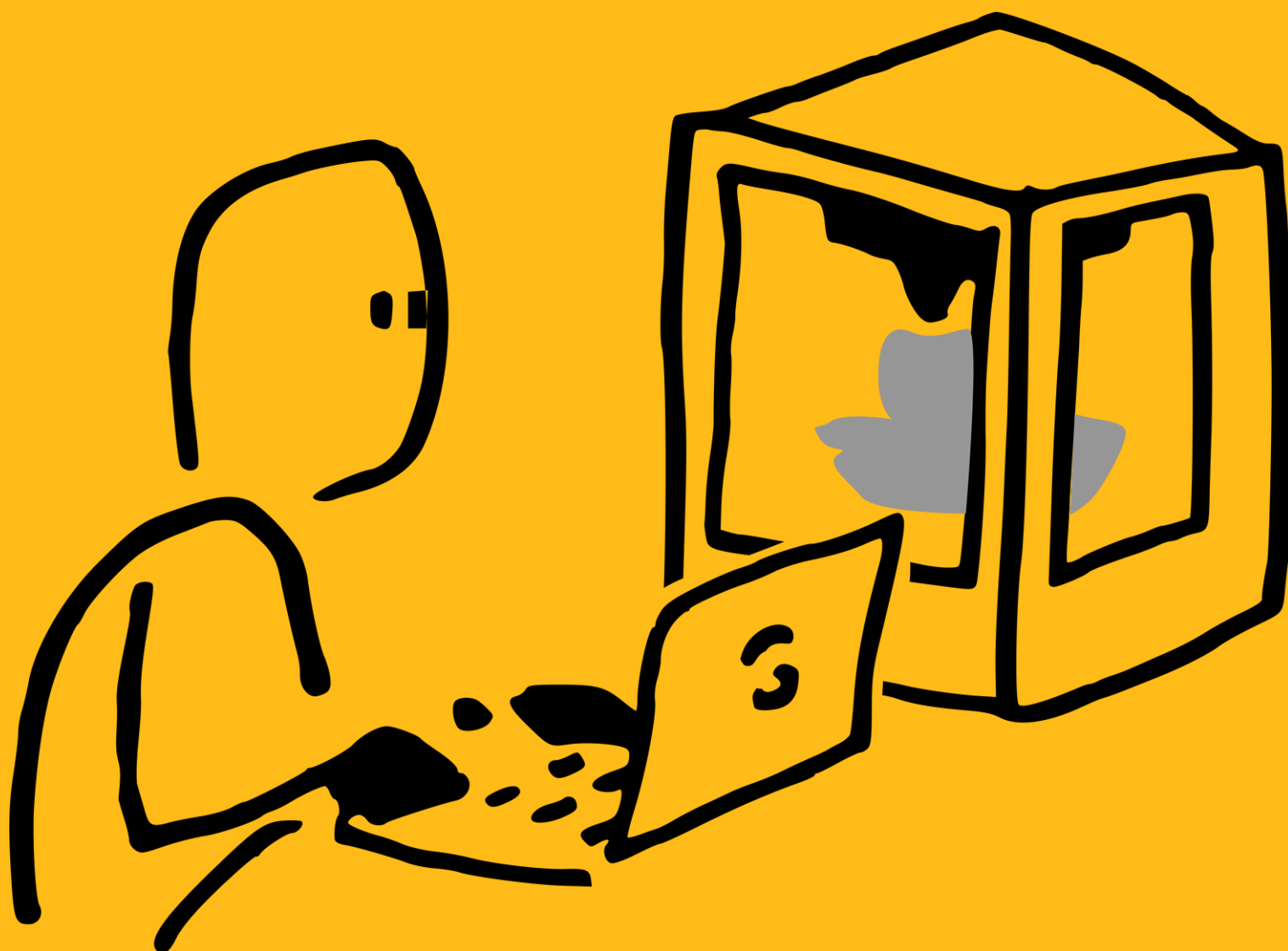




Singleton

All things you should know about Singleton.



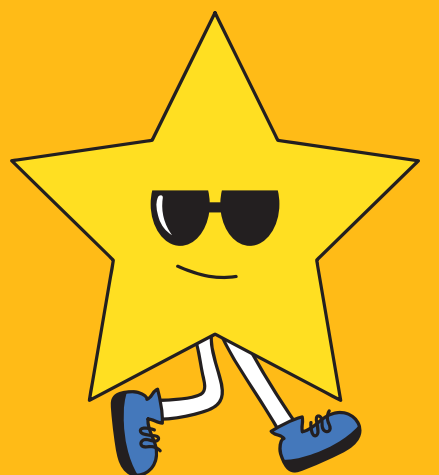
What?

It belongs to the creational category.

Make sure a class has only one instance and provides a global point of access to it.



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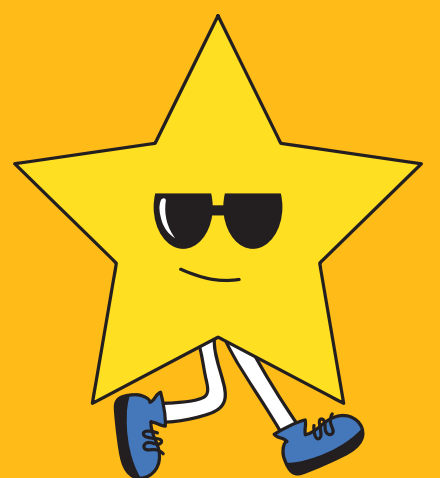
Problem



Assume, we want to write an accounting system that should be dedicated to serving one company. Therefore, we need to ensure a class has only one instance and the instance is easily accessible. How can we do it?



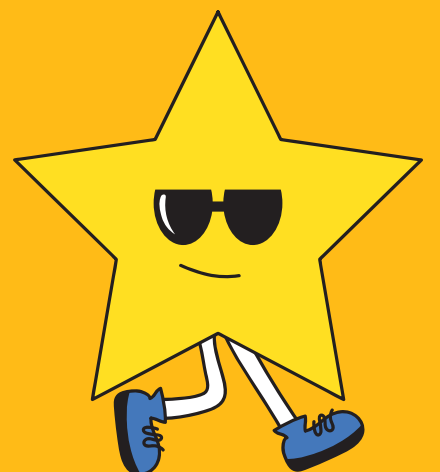
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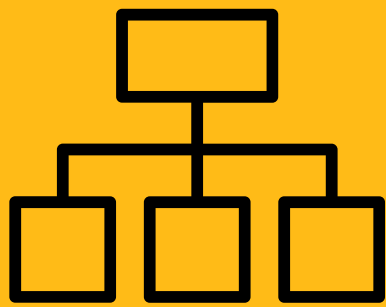




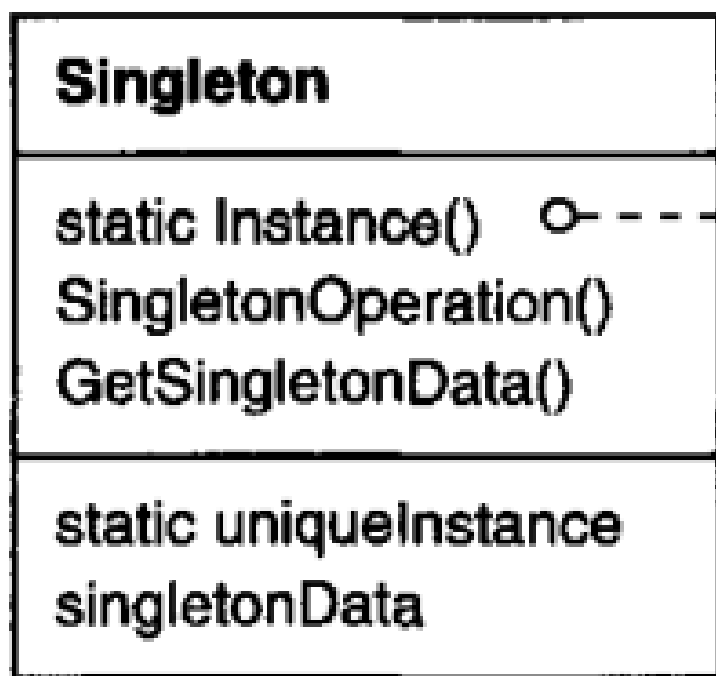
Solution

The class is responsible for keeping track of its sole instance. This is called **Singleton**.





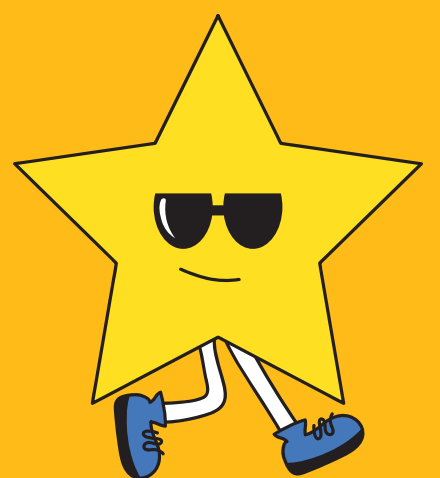
Structure



return uniqueInstance



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Usability

There must be exactly one instance of a class, and also it must be accessible to clients from a well-known access point.

When the sole instance should be extensible by subclassing, and clients should be able to use an extended instance **without modifying** their code.



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